

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1987-08-20

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,
2 your letter of 22 july 1987 has been received by the universal house of
justice, which has asked us to respond as follows.33.8

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36 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

37 66The provisions set out in the letter of 17 july 1978 written to your Na-
38 tional Spiritual Assembly on behalf of the house of justice remain appli-
39 cable, including the principle that it is improper for bahá'ís to solicit funds
40 from non-b ahá'ís in the name of the f aith for any purpose.

41 The following passage from the pen of bahá'u'lláh: "i t would be impos-
42 sible to conceive any act more contemptible than soliciting, in the name of
43 the one true god, the riches which men possess"35-1 clearly indicates what
44 the attitude of the b ahá'ís should be.

There is, however, a wide range of fund-raising activities in which

45 bahá'ís may engage. for example, bahá'í institutions are free to approach
46 governments or institutions which hold themselves out as wishing to fund
47 charitable activities, to apply for grants to assist in specific humanitarian
48 projects. A bahá'í school which has both bahá'í and non-b ahá'í pupils is
49 free to raise funds for its own development by such activities as concerts,
50 etc., or by appeals to parents; in this instance, a humanitarian institution is clearly
identified, and the funds are being collected in its name rather than
51 in the name of the faith. Another example is that of a bahá'í who wishes to
52 sell an item he owns to the general public for a fair market price; he is free to
53 use the proceeds for any purpose he wishes, including contributing them all,
54 or in part, to the bahá'í fund, provided he does not represent to the public

55 that the sale is being conducted for the benefit of the faith.

There would be no objection to the bahá'í community's joining with

56 others to give a concert or undertake some other similar activity to raise funds for a
deserving charity. Such activities or even the making of dona-

57 tions to humanitarian work should be, and should be seen to be, acts of sin-cere
assistance and cooperation. in choosing to engage in such fund-raising,

58 a bahá'í community would need to ensure that assisting the charity would

59 not have partisan political implications or support purposes contrary to the interests
of the faith. it would need to watch carefully that its involvement

60 in such activities does not divert its energies from the vital work of teaching

61 the faith and consolidating its institutions.

62 with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat

63 35-1. gwb, no. 100.2.35.2

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36 1986-1992 • The Six Year Plan

37 6736

Plans for Development of the Buildings

on the Arc and Terraces

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]